

NATURAL LEADERSHIP: A CORE COMPETENCY OF CLARITY

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One moment at a time,
One relationship at a time,
Always for the benefit of all

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*Every forest branch moves differently in the breeze,
but as they sway, they connect at the roots.*

~ Rumi

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What is Natural Leadership?

Imagine being a leader in your company who operates with clarity, ease and authenticity as your partners. Imagine generating extraordinary results without drama and constant conflict. Imagine knowing moment to moment that your team is aligned and synergistic and working with a shared vision of success ... that is Natural Leadership.

You already are a successful leader or you wouldn't be reading this. Already you have learned quite a bit. Yet, you are not always able to take what you know and use it in difficult situations. You are really good at what you do. Yet, because of the extreme complexity of our times, we need to rely on clarity as our core competency for success. We see ground-breaking and innovative developments in connectivity and technology, business methodologies, personal awareness and change paradigms day by day. Without clarity, authenticity and a good sense of humour, we will most likely be behind the curve as late adaptors rather than the leaders during these times.

Natural Leadership is the ability we are all born with to do the right thing. When informed by clarity, we have a true sense of our natural ethics, and our authority. We know that these abilities infuse the fabric of our lives.

We also need extraordinary business skills, emotional intelligence, and the personal disciplines of Natural Leadership.

As we gain confidence in the clarity of our vision, opportunities for Natural Leadership are more available and accessible. As we gain confidence in our decision-making in this paradigm, the critical leadership skills of clarity-based intelligence emerge. This fosters instinctive confidence that leads to superior performance with high effectiveness and efficiency.

We empower our employees and those around us to trust their natural authority, to thrive in their skills and talents and become Natural Leaders. You, your employees, customers, vendors, shareholders, and family immediately experience benefit from being with you.

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Purpose, Vision, Mission and Guiding Principles

We all have a *purpose*, our reason for being born. Living it creates immense joy and freedom. Some of us remember our purpose and some do not. When we were children, we had a connection with our purpose. It was as natural to us as breathing. It served as a backdrop of the games we played, the books we read, the people we were drawn to, the dreams we had and the feelings and thoughts that seemed to come out of nowhere. Many of us lose that connection; some of us may not even remember we had it. Regardless, without it, it doesn't matter how much money and power we accumulate, most of us are conscious of something missing, an ache, a loneliness and we will create crisis after crisis in an effort to find the missing piece.

A *vision* is a picture of our purpose brought to life. As we evolve through education, and life experiences, we re-find our purpose, we bring our purpose to life with a vision that helps us navigate our life experiences. We create a *mission* that supports our day-to-day life. This gives us a natural foundation and meaning we need to make a difference for the benefit of all.

If we live our vision, what will be the result? For example, we may want to help people. Our vision is a safe world for all. Our mission is the way we personally live our vision, for instance by becoming a firefighter. We do our best to insure people's safety when there are fires. We fulfill our mission of helping people and work toward our vision of a safe world. There are an infinite number of ways to fulfill the vision of a safe world. And as you might expect, we express this through our individual unique conditioning. Yet, just by being alive, we can all share a common vision, purpose and mission, such as "for the benefit of all." This *Guidebook* will make that clear.

To forge a direct pathway to clarity, we need to look at our beliefs about the world and ourselves. Beliefs are what we unquestionably think is true. Much of this "truth" is stored in each cell of our body-mind. Many of us don't even notice or think about what we believe and how this affects our decision-making.

When our purpose, vision and mission inform our decisions, life works. If we live our vision informed by clarity, integrity and responsibility, we are inspired to grow no matter how we feel. We are focused on the big picture, rather than the moment-by-moment situation.

Regardless of the environment where we as leaders are headed – corporate, non-profit, public or community service – responsible action informed by clarity and the vision of the organization, creates an irresistible magnetism to draw the resources, people and events necessary for us to accomplish our goals.

Guiding principles are how we live our purpose, vision and mission. Guiding principles are fundamental truths that serve as rules and agreements that govern our personal behavior. They are the source and basis for the success of living our purpose, vision and mission.

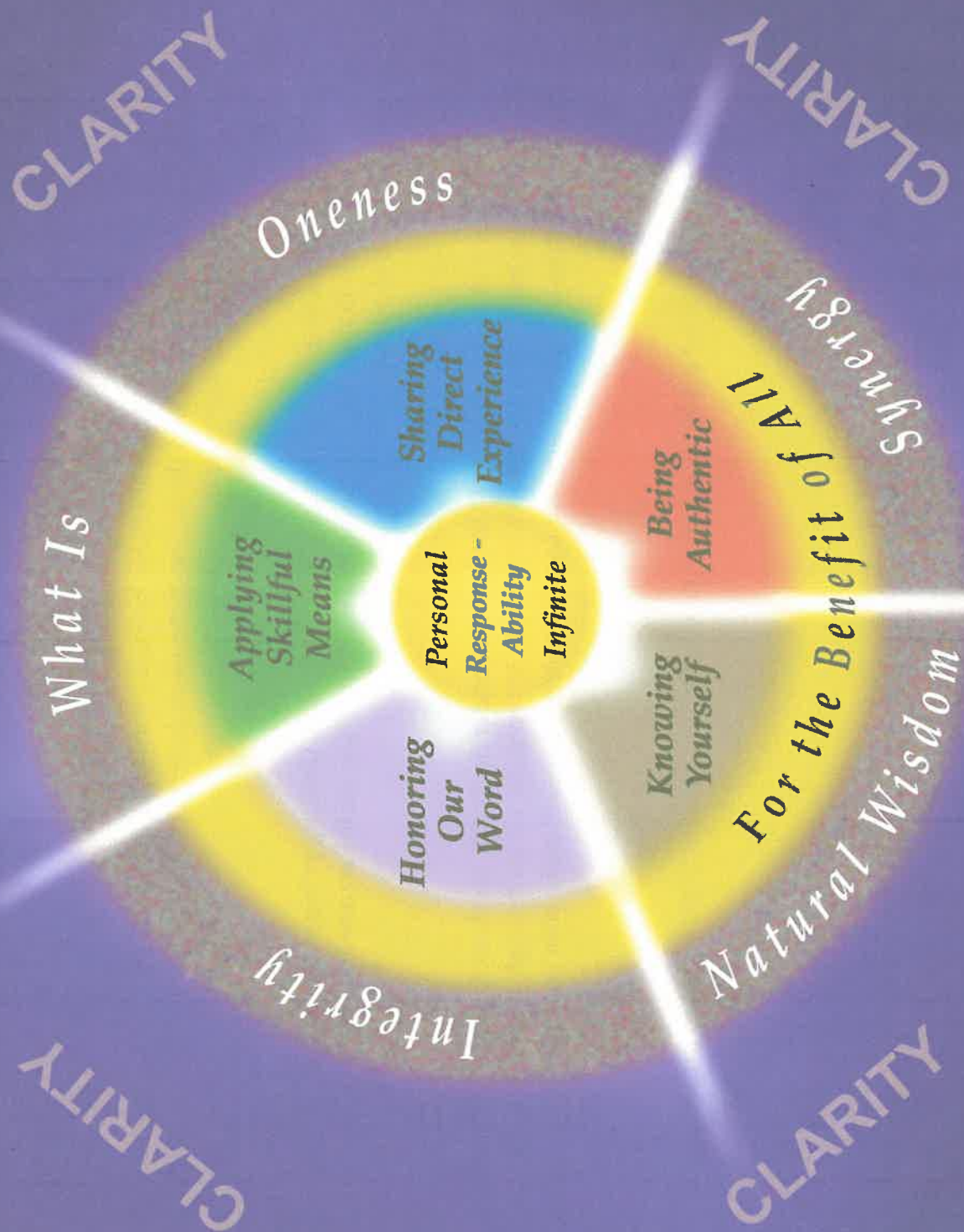
The Natural Leadership: A Core Competency of Clarity is an “under the hood” methodology that has evolved through the participation of many organizations over the last 30 years. As we go through this process together, please make sure you address all your considerations and concerns. We will make sure your questions are answered completely.

A Natural Leader is someone who understands the responsibility that comes with clarity and freedom.

~ Judith Orloff, M.Ed.



NATURAL LEADERSHIP: A CORE COMPETENCY OF CLARITY

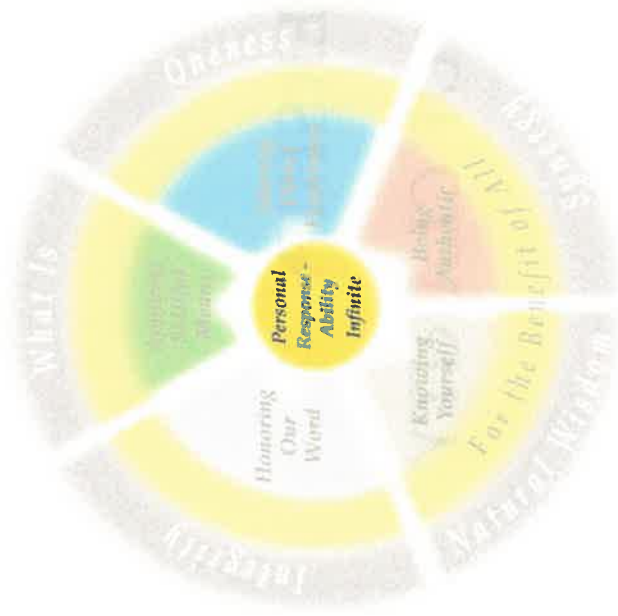


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Notes and Reflections



Guiding Principle #1 – Personal Responsibility

Being personally responsible (response-able) means mastering the ability to respond to each situation, each moment, with unlimited options, always for the benefit of all.

Personal Response-Ability



Being Accountable for Results

We know we are the source of our experience and our life. We grow with the ability to be responsible for how we feel, think and behave. We know we are the author and owner of the results we have created in our life.

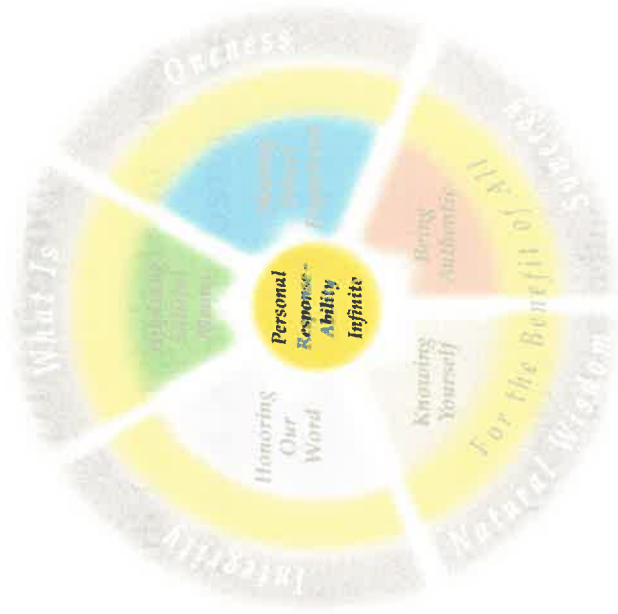
BENEFITS:

Being the source of our life journey
Personal evolution and transformation

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Notes and Reflections



Personal Response-Ability



Allowing Many Alternatives

In an environment of clarity and personal response-ability, participation from everyone is natural. All want to share and be connected with the community they are part of at any time. Accessing our direct experience with each other allows for solutions that include everyone's gifts and talents.

BENEFITS:

Being open to whatever arises in clarity
Natural collaboration and synergy

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Personal Response-Ability



Congruence: Transparency and Harmony

When we are congruent, our thoughts, feelings and actions are aligned. Congruence allows everyone to respond, always for the benefit of all. There is no separation between inside and outside. We have one face.

BENEFITS:

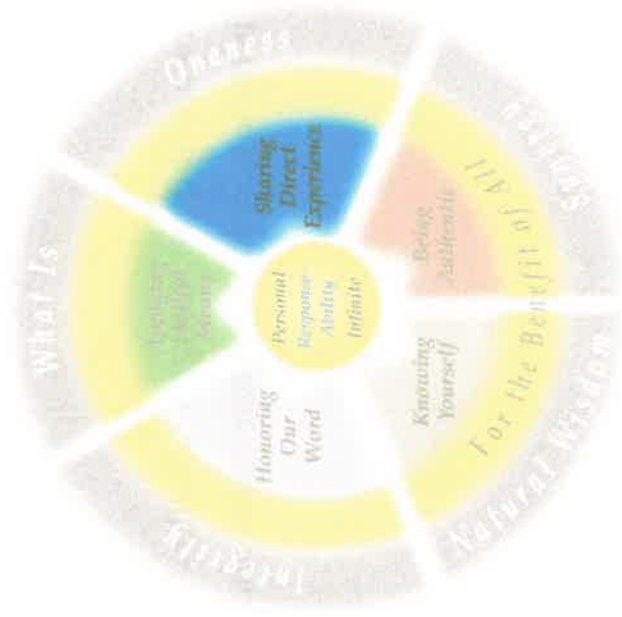
- Ease of connection
- Trusting relationships
- Alignment within and without

The result in mastering the competency of Personal Responsibility is trust in life itself

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Notes and Reflections



Guiding Principle #2 – Sharing Direct Experience

Honesty about our experience, informed by clarity is what allows for transformation. Giving and receiving feedback with “good purpose” means sharing your direct experience with nothing added or withheld. This is a direct path into clarity and feelings of connection.

Sharing Direct Experience



Listening and Receiving

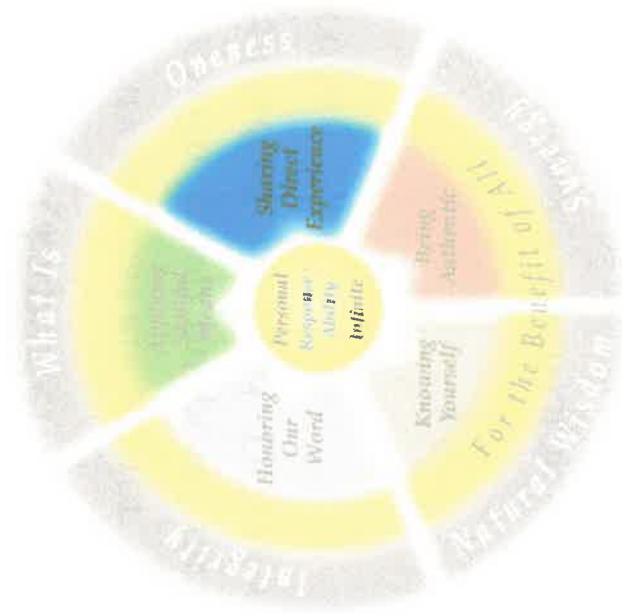
Our direct experience is that which is true in us, about us, in the moment without interpretation, right here, right now. When we share our direct experience, it cannot be argued with – it is just about ourselves! We don't defend, take care of, manipulate, blame or continue to make our point. Black and white, right and wrong are no longer our perspective; rather, different perspectives become openings for intimate conversation.

BENEFITS:

- Open-hearted communication
- Natural intimacy
- Experience of oneness



Notes and Reflections



Sharing Direct Experience



Opportunity for Transformation

The open-hearted understanding that is the result of Radically Listening to another transforms our personal experience of ourselves. Willingness to receive what others are giving us is critical for transformation. When we feel threatened, we need to remember that what feels threatened cannot be real.

BENEFITS:

Vulnerability
Natural learning

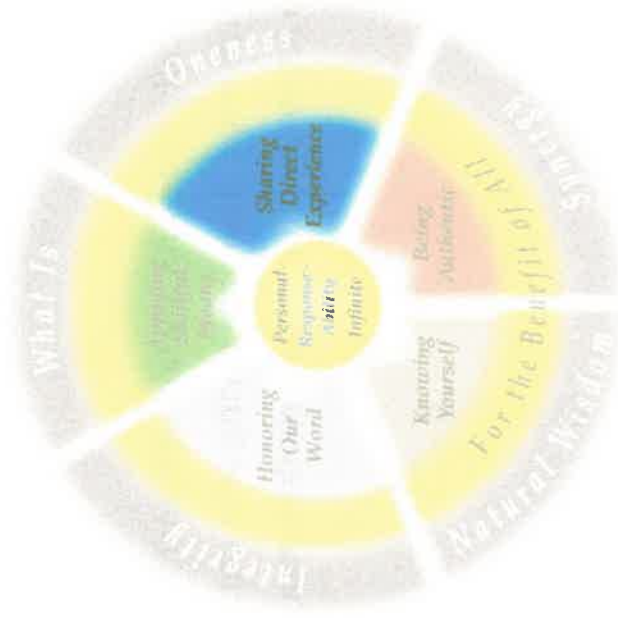
The only source of knowledge is experience.

~ Einstein

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Sharing Direct Experience



Without Defense, Justification or Explanation

It is unnecessary to search for the root cause of our successes, failures and mistakes. When we defend, justify or explain, we strengthen our points of view and lose sight of “what is” right here and now. We can share what is true for us and just move on without leaving a trace. We need not worry about how we appear when we share our direct experience.

BENEFITS:

Natural affinity and partnership

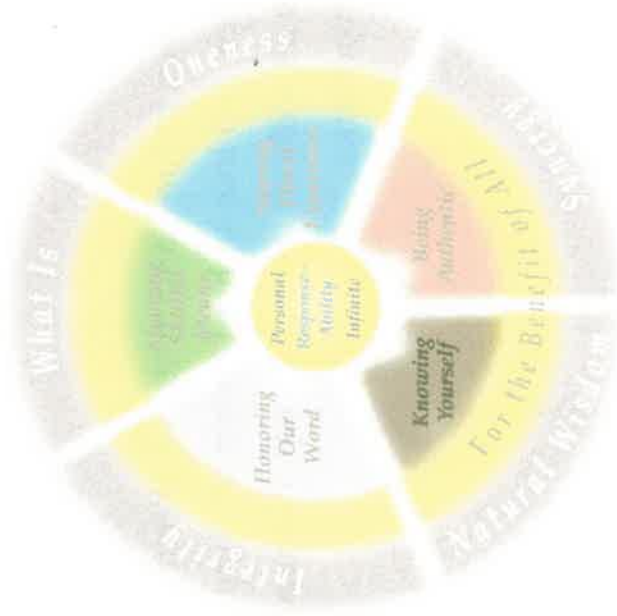
Right and wrong dissolve into natural ethics

The result of mastering the competency of Sharing our Direct Experience is oneness

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Guiding Principle #3 – Knowing Yourself

Knowing our self and our points of view allows us to walk in the world without fear of loss and the need to control our environment.

Knowing Yourself

Understanding Our True Nature

Our true nature is clarity. Other names for clarity can be unconditional love, Buddha mind, God and non-dual awareness. Just spend time with a small child and watch how life moves through them without self-consciousness. As we grow up, we tend to lose the wisdom we had as a small child. Instead, we rely more on our conditioning. We believe our points of view are who we are, and we want others to share our beliefs and values. We often argue for our perspective to be the right one. Relaxing our points of view allows us to see “into clarity” and experience our true nature.

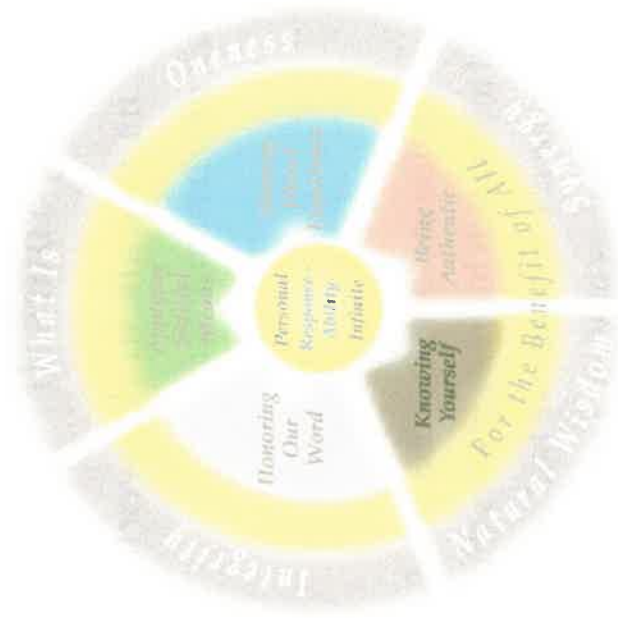
BENEFIT:

Reliance on clarity for everyday life situations

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Knowing Yourself



Assuming Innocence

Every adult was once a child and was innocent. Assuming innocence in motivation is a challenging competency to live by. Even though a particular perspective may be incomprehensible to us, it is not to the other person. By assuming innocence in everyday situations, we are not bound to any particular response. Our solutions are comprehensive and arise from a natural intelligence and are for the benefit of all.

BENEFITS:

Trusting your direct experience

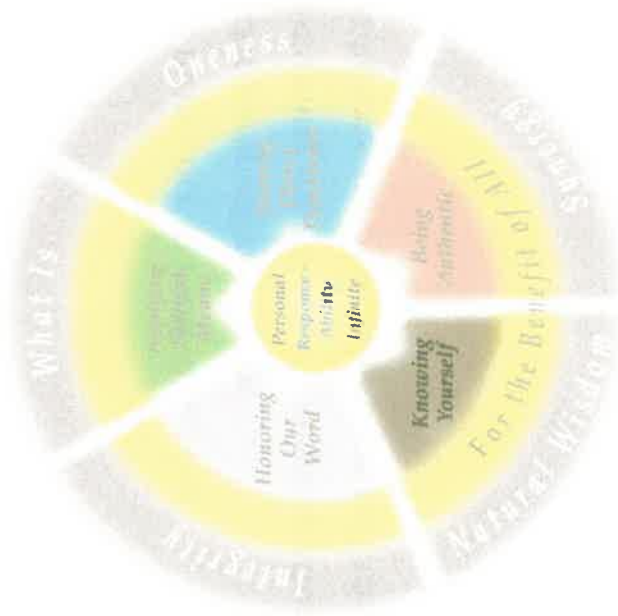
Acceptance of "what is"

Choosing from infinite possibilities

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Knowing Yourself

Uniting Our Personal Vision with a Larger Perspective, for the Benefit of All

Although we are all equal, we are also unique. We have natural gifts and talents that are part of our uniqueness. Everyone is unique, no one is special. When we live and work together, we can evolve and transform so that we move closer to our vision, and our mission can be lived more effectively.

BENEFIT:

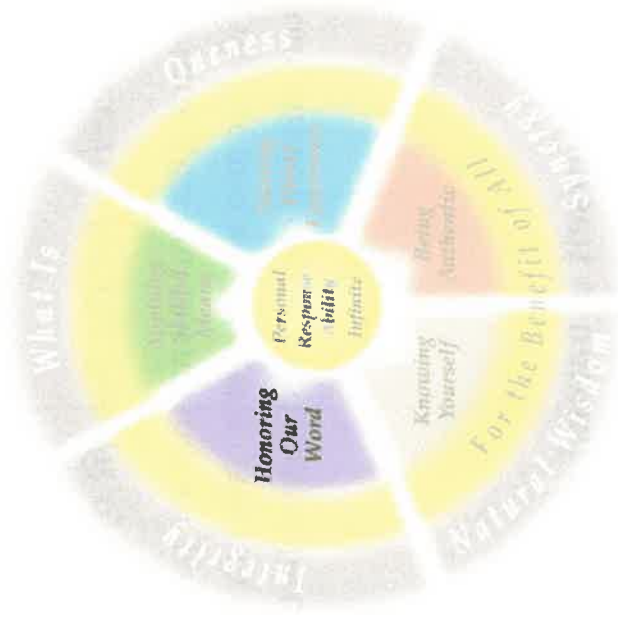
Vision and mission are large enough for all to participate equally

The result in mastering the competency of Knowing Yourself is natural wisdom, natural authority and natural ethics

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Guiding Principle #4 – Honoring Our Word

Honor and keep our word.

Honoring Our Word



Keeping Our Word

Keeping our word is simply doing what we say. If we are not accountable to our word, we are not in integrity. Our lives cannot work in ways that bring us satisfaction and joy.

BENEFITS:

Integrity

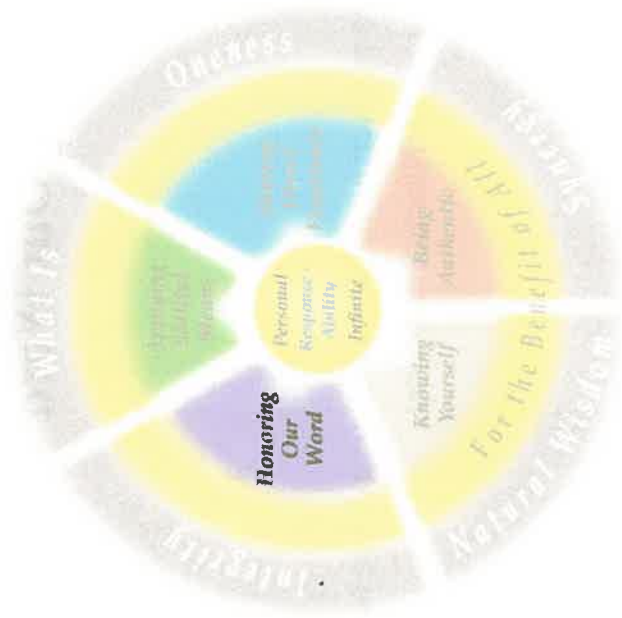
The state of being complete and whole

Strengthened connection to life

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Honoring our Word



Timely Communication

Although keeping our word is fundamental to happiness and contentment, we will not always be able to do so, especially as we grow in our influence and Natural Leadership. Life presents situations that call for our attention. As soon as we become aware that we are unable to keep our word, it is important to communicate this and to make sure all involved feel whole. When communication is timely we are “honoring our word.” This can only be positive.

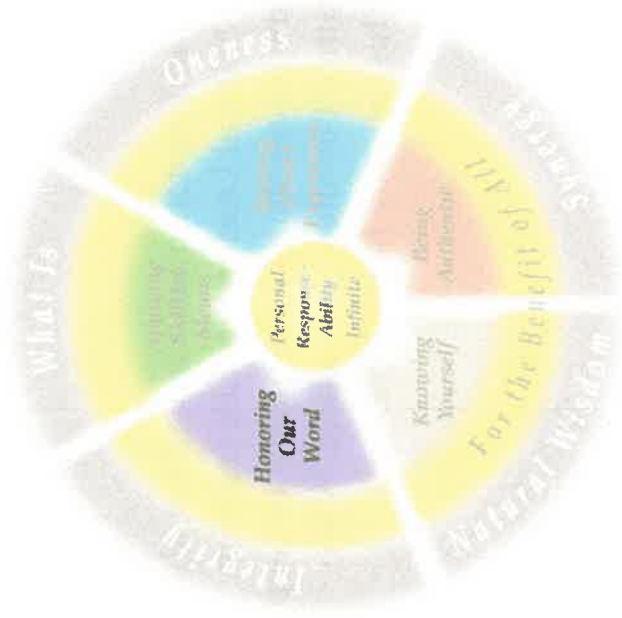
BENEFITS:

- Respect-infused relationships
- Everyday fulfillment
- Care-free life experience

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Honoring our Word



Free Choice

A Free Choice is one made after authentic consideration of benefit and without situational conditions. Before making a Free Choice it is important to consider all options, experience all points of view and remember that all perspectives are equal and connected. Our personal vision and mission can lead the way in determining our Free Choice.

BENEFITS:

Decisions informed by clarity

Consideration of all points of view, options and suggestions

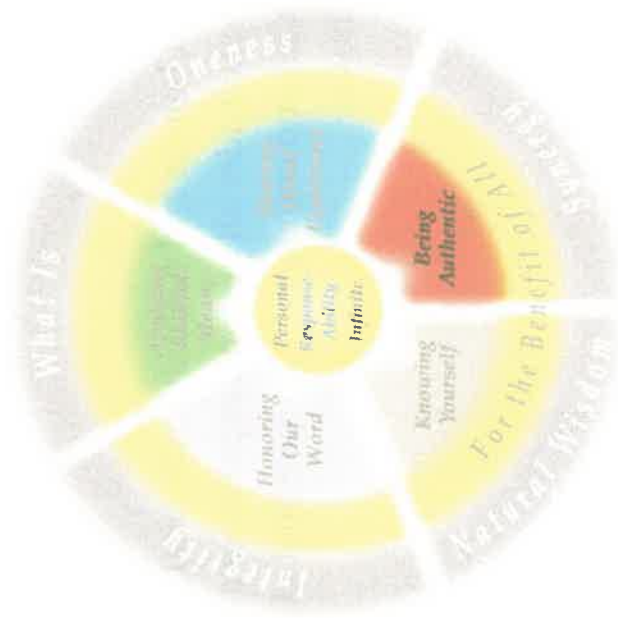
Knowing that all perspectives are equal and connected

The result in mastering the competency of Honoring Our Word is integrity

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Guiding Principle #5 – Being Authentic

Authenticity is undisputed credibility and genuineness. We view ourselves and others as equal. Although we have unique roles and responsibilities, we are equal beings.

Being Authentic



Communicating What Is True without Pretense

We are true to our character and spirit, no matter what the situation or environment. With authenticity as our natural way of being, we have access to knowing who we are and can live for the benefit of all.

BENEFITS:

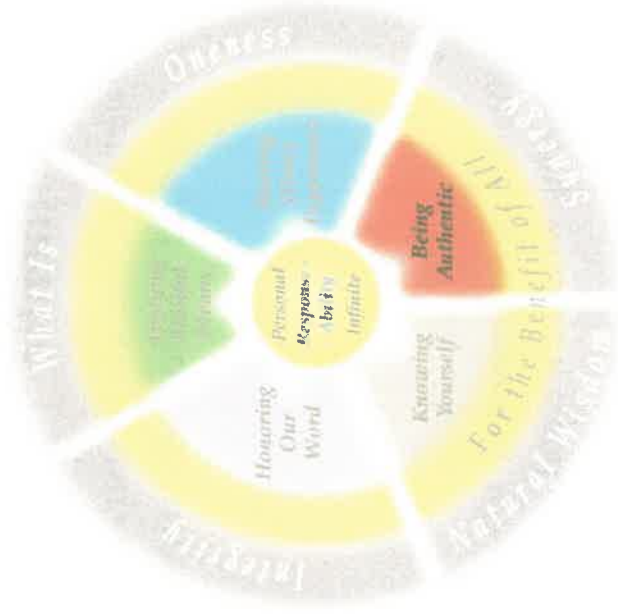
Embodiment of clarity and oneness

Feeling good about ourselves

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Being Authentic



Embodying Trust and Equality

From a Natural Leadership perspective we create the experience of trust and equality by embodiment of these qualities. Trust is complete reliance on the integrity, natural authority and clarity of oneself. Equality is the capability for each of us to use our natural gifts and talents to live a joyful life.

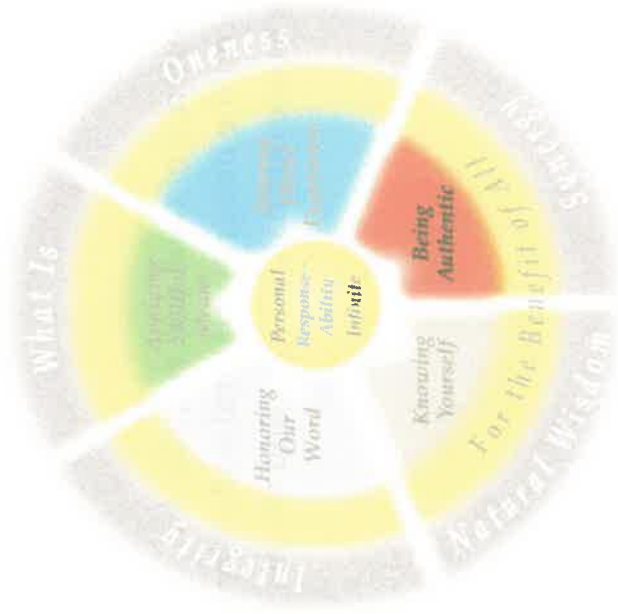
BENEFIT:

Naturally healthy life style

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Being Authentic



Awareness of Intention before Taking Action

By relying on clarity we see our intention each time we act. Sometimes it moves by very quickly and we catch it by noticing the response we receive. With practice, we naturally become aware of our moment-by-moment intention and our actions become consistent with our vision and mission.

BENEFITS:

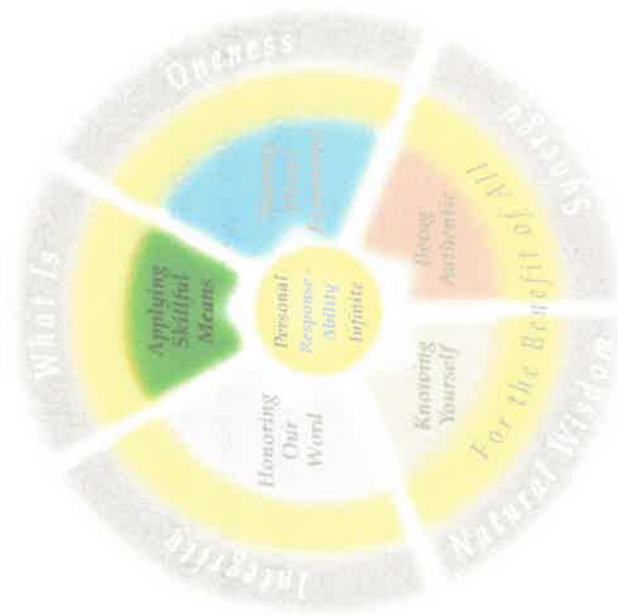
Fear and doubt disappear
Uniqueness and interdependence move as one
Synergy

The result in mastering the competency of Being Authentic is synergy

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Guiding Principle #6 – Applying Skillful Means

Using Skillful Means allows us to know what actions to take in all situations. Skillful Means point to truth, and are extremely flexible and contradictory. Only when we are relying on clarity can we use Skillful Means. Each situation is unique and each person is unique. Clarity points us to what makes sense in each moment with each situation. Natural Leaders choose their Means to suit the individual or group they are leading.

Applying Skillful Means



Seeing through Our Reactions

As we thin our reactions, we grow our capability to look beyond any particular behavior to the open space of clarity. We can now approach any situation with compassion. We rely on clarity to use Skillful Means.

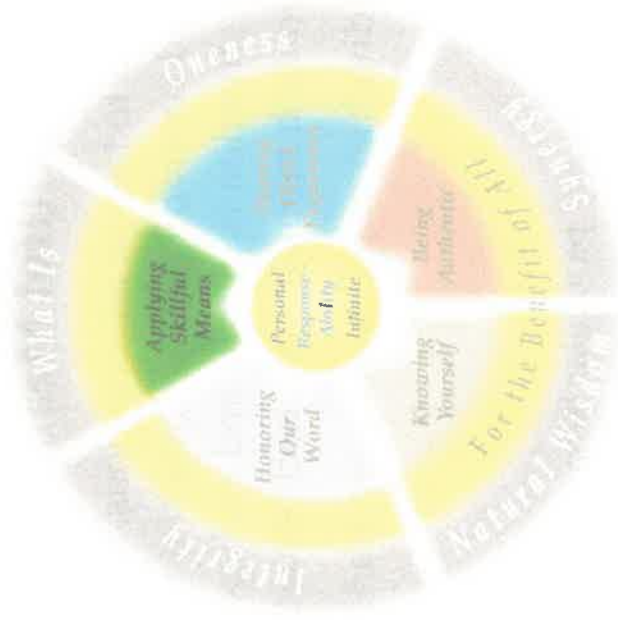
BENEFIT:

Fierce compassion

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Applying Skillful Means

Thinning Our Conditioning

When we are responsible, we depend more on clarity than on conditioning. We are able to move through painful patterns to open space and make decisions that support our vision and mission.

BENEFITS:

Artful seeing

Unlimited options

Love is the only reality and it is not a mere sentiment.

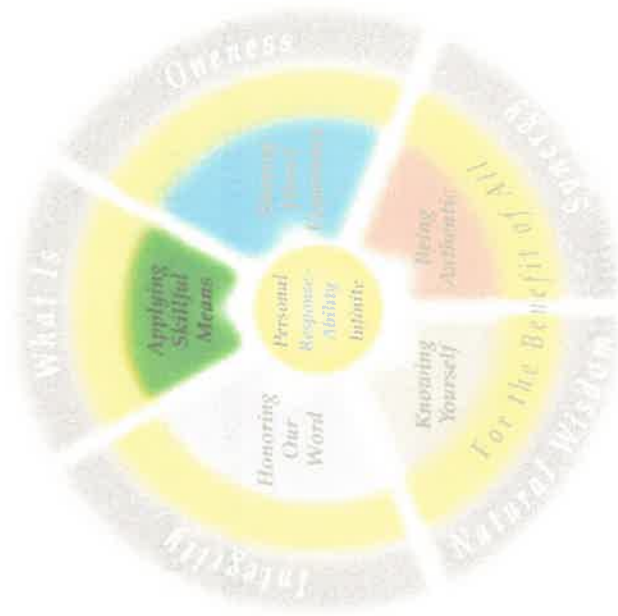
Love is the ultimate truth that lies at the heart of creation.

~ Tagore

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Applying Skillful Means



Opening Our Heart and Mind

Sharing our direct experience in the moment, rather than thoughts, judgments and solutions creates space for transformation. Feedback, when presented side by side with awareness, touches the hearts and minds of those we connect with.

BENEFITS:

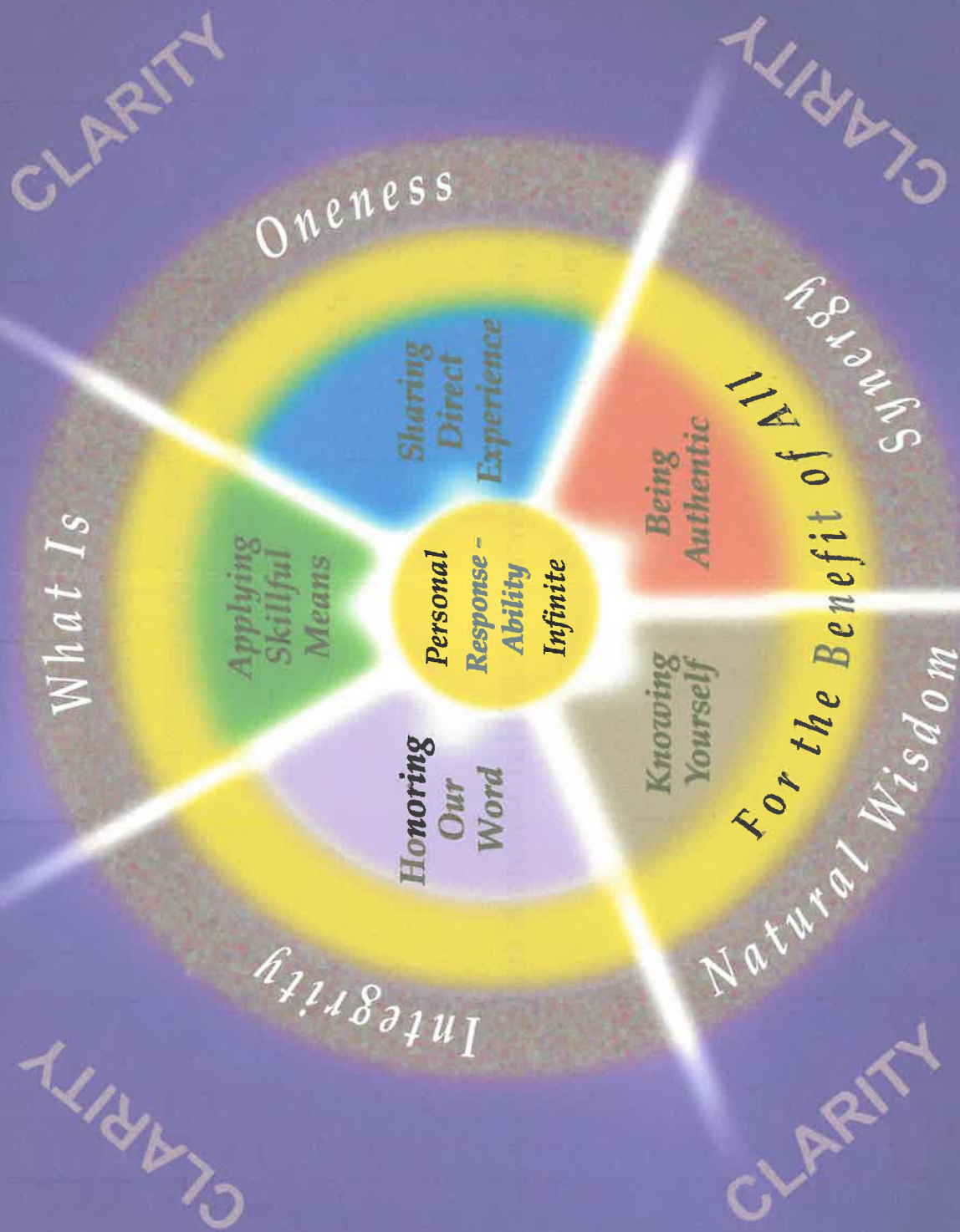
Experiencing the essence of “what is”
Open-hearted authority

The result in mastering the competencies of Skillful Means is seeing each person as capable of wholeness

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Natural Leadership: A Core Competency of Clarity

The result in mastering the competencies of Natural Leadership is
inseparability of clarity and everyday life

Leadership is about creating a domain in which human beings continually deepen their understanding of reality and become more capable of participating in the unfolding of the world. Ultimately, leadership is about creating new realities.

~ Peter M. Senge

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